Nethy’s Preservation Guide

Updated 23/03/2026

Intro

This guide exists just so I have something to link people when they ask questions I get often, so the focus is primarily on talents, gear and spell explanations and it’s a bit barebones till I can be bothered touching it up. I am a bit too busy to make a “Full guide”, but I might get around to it at a later point, additionally it’s quickly put together so that it’s ready for season launch.

I will do my best to maintain the guide and add to it over time so that it remains relevant, but do keep in mind this is my hobby and not the most important thing in my life.
Hopefully this helps more people getting into and enjoy what is by far the most fun spec in WoW PVP

If anything is confusing, your questions aren't answered here. Feel free to join the Evoker discord (https://discord.com/invite/evoker) and ask me in the Preservation-pvp channel, I do not respond to discord DMs from strangers, so please just tag me in the channel and I’ll respond when I can usually, I enjoy chatting about evoker.

Links:
I very rarely stream on: https://www.twitch.tv/nethylol
I complain about wow on: https://x.com/nethylol
If the guide helped you a lot and you want to buy me a coffee you can do so here: https://streamlabs.com/nethylol/tip

Are we meta?

Preservation evoker is currently a mid-tier healer and will probably be a lower-mid tier healer after the nerf, It is however very strong when piloted correctly, especially in 3s, but incredibly punishing as evoker is notoriously squishy in stuns.

- **Solo Shuffle:** Pres is always at least decent in shuffle, Pres is usually on a timer because of our mana and CDs reduced by dampening. The aggro playstyle is a lot easier to pull off in shuffle where people are not coordinated as well, as people are much less likely to punish you.
- **3v3:** Pres will be strong in 3v3, but historically cannot plug into any comp, you will want to play a CC heavy comp that tries to finish the game fast, as we are on a short timer compared to most other healers. Once the meta is settled I’ll maybe add a “Comps and matchup” section, this early it’s hard to tell. But look for comps that are very aggro like melee cleaves or rogue/feral + caster comps.

Talents

3v3 / 2v2

Recommended generally, Flameshaper:



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AsNzMTzYMzMLjZAgxMjZW2YxCDzMz0QzGjNDjZGMzwA

Alternative build, Best for 2v2: Chronowarden:



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AsNzMTzYMzMLjZAgxMjZW2YxCDzMz0QzGjFDjZGMzwA

What should I play?

Note: Section only talks about the differences in the builds, see rotation part if you want to know how to actually play.

1. Flameshaper (Default 3v3 build)

Should be your default build if you're new to Evoker or unsure which build fits your comp, it's your go-to for consistent HPS and survival. It's good in all matchups, even the ones where Chronowarden would be better.

- Focuses Primarily on Dream Breath. You should heavily prioritise uptime of this HoT on the enemy's kill target all the time.
- Your Verdant Embrace is a wet noodle unless it "eats" the Dream Breath HoT via Consume Flame. This is your primary burst heal loop, outside of Golden hour.
- Lifecinders allows you to share Obsidian Scales (including Renewing Blaze and Aura Mastery) with a teammate. It's a 15% wall that gives you one more tradeable CD.

Note, re. season launch buffs: Flameshaper does **not** have any talents that buff the initial heal of Dream Breath. The buff to the initial heal provided by Merithra's Blessing 4/4 buffs Chronowarden and Flameshaper equally; the buff does not make Flameshaper mandatory.

2. Chronowarden (Aggro 3v3, Default 2v2 build)

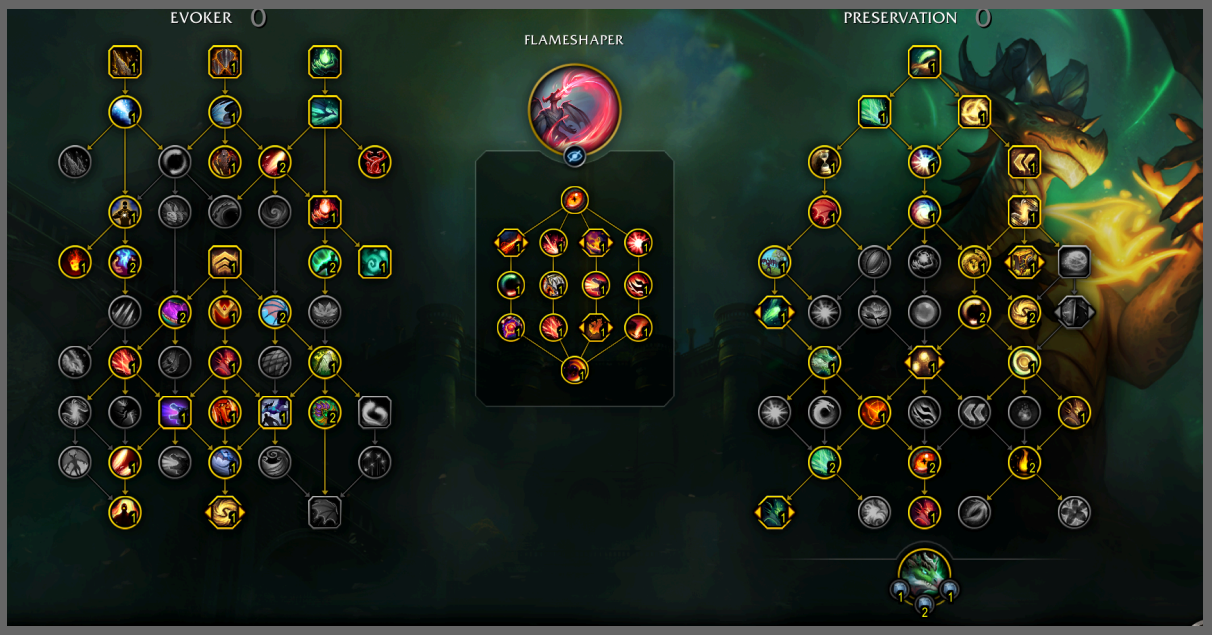
A completely viable and strong alternative, and even potentially meta if the games are very quick, Chrono has less sustained overall HPS, higher burst healing, damage and stats.

- Primacy provides a near-permanent 9% Haste advantage over Flameshaper. This is massive for the early seasons where stats are a premium.
- Your living flame is buffed and turned into Chronoflame, additionally Afterimage fires free Chronoflames during empowers, significantly increasing the initial burst heal of Dream Breath, and burst damage on firebreath.
- You lose the 15% wall from flameshaper, but gain Temporal Burst, which turns Tip the Scales into a personal Bloodlust, massively buffing your Haste and CDR for 30 seconds, this opens up for huge burst damage windows, but it is also high value for healing.
- Chrono flames can proc essence bursts, so you will generally have more Essence Burst procs as chronowarden, which means more free Disintegrates and Merithra's Blessing fishing, and overall less mana munching.

Note: The builds right now are only differing in hero talent selection, this might change in the .5 patch with Temporal anomaly and Chronowarden changes, I'll probably update this section once .5 is out.

Solo Shuffle

Default build: Flameshaper



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AsNzMTzYMzMLjZAgxMjZW2YxCDzMz0QzGjNDjZGMzwA

Aggro build: Chronowarden



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AsNzMTzYMzMLjZAgxMjZW2YxCDzMz0QzGjFDjZGMzwA

What should I play?

In shuffle the difference between chronowarden and flameshaper is a lot smaller, but I still recommend flameshaper for someone just starting out, you might see top evokers using Chronowarden more in high end Shuffle though as the hyperaggro playstyle is punished a lot less in shuffle than it is in 3v3.

The main differences between 3v3 and shuffle is that mana is no longer a consistent concern, so you can drop Energy loop for Time of Need for a more consistent “Cheat death” aid vs burst damage. Note that Flameshaper uses disintegrate a lot more for damage than chronowarden, so you can opt into playing the 3v3 flameshaper build in Shuffle if you want your blue beam to do damage.

If you’re more interested in the differences, see the 3v3 section.

PVP talents

You will always play **Nullifying Shroud** and **Emerald Communion**.

For your 3rd talent you will usually pick between: Obsidian Mettle, Unburdened Flight and Timestop:

- **Obsidian Mettle (Recommended for beginners)** is your go to for most matchups, it’s interrupt immunity on your Obsidian scales, useful to get sleepwalks.
- **Unburdened Flight** is great if you are getting permanently trained and want to have an easier time kiting.
- **Timestop (Best)** is an “Advanced” talent, you can read about timestop in the CC immunity section, it is insanely strong when used correctly, as addons cannot track the buff uptime on Timestop currently, which means you can immune CC much easier than in TWW.

Gearing

- **TL;DR:** Haste > Vers > Mastery
- Buy conquest gear, buy Haste Vers when you can, if there’s no Haste Vers option get the Mastery Vers one.
- **Crafting:** Craft a neck and 2 rings. Two should have Haste Vers, one should have Haste Mastery
    - Put Blessed Pango Charm on your rings, embellishments are not that strong or important this season.
- **Tier set:** No matter what build you play, you want 4 set, your builds might change when we get 4 set, guide will be updated once I get 4 set myself and get to play around with it.
    - The tier pieces you want to use are: Head / Shoulders / Hands / legs

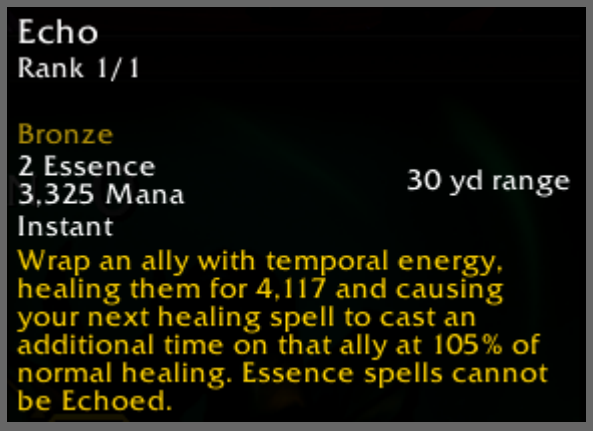
How to play

A quick rundown on important spells, cooldowns and how to play, I won't cover literally every spell just the ones where I feel like you'd need explanation beyond the surface level, so I won't explain Dispell, deepbreath, hover and so on, I feel like it's obvious what those spells do, if you are completely new to healing and want a hyper detailed breakdown I highly recommend looking up a PVE healing guide like one on wowhead to get an idea for how all your spells work and then coming back to this for the PVP specifics.

Healing Rotation

Evoker can feel like it does no healing when you start out, evoker has probably the highest HPS currently in arena when played optimally but the rotation can be unintuitive if you are not used to it.
The best way to learn it is by just going into shuffle and getting a feel for it, there's no specific rotation to evoker so I will not give you an easy rotation, I'll instead explain what spells do and when you'd want to use them:

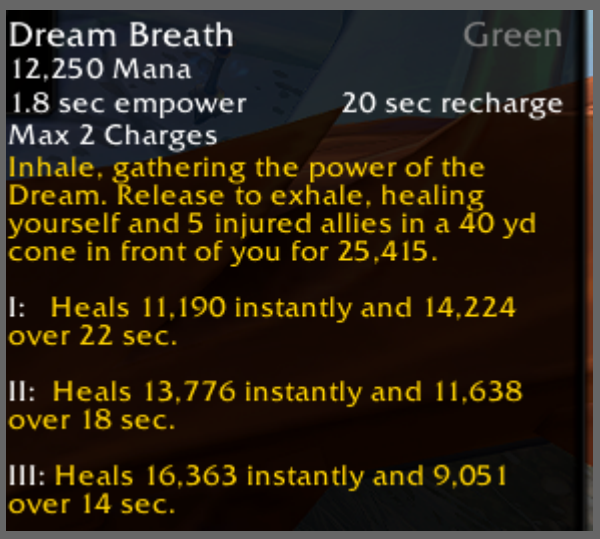
Echo:



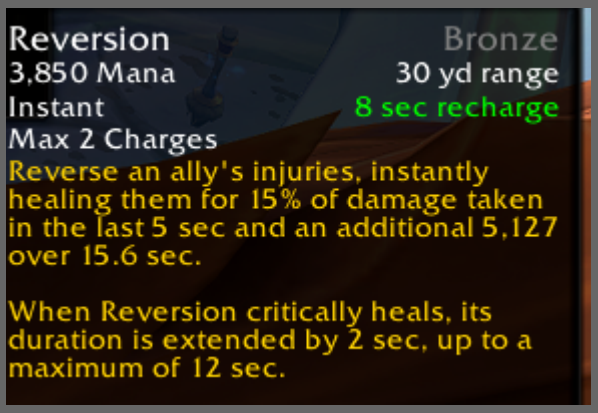
Echo is a critical spell in how evoker plays, echo is quite simple, it copies the next non-cooldown healing spell you press. Echo should be used frequently, you can use it to cleave heal on spells that are usually single target, additionally it can copy on your primary target. This means if you Echo a guy and then Verdant Embrace, you will heal him for 205% of what you'd do with just Verdant Embrace alone.

Echo also allows you to "Double up" on hots, reversion or dream breath is technically a different spell when echo'd, this means that if you echo Dream breath or echo Reversion, you will have 2 hots on the target, rather than 1 that overrides itself.

Hots:

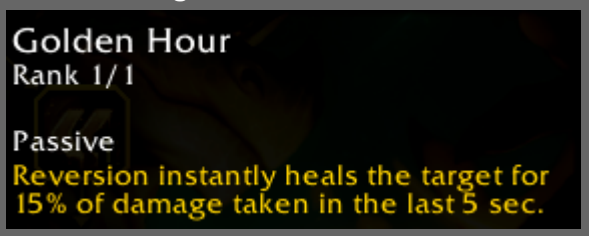


Dream breath is a huge HoT you'd generally want to have as high of an uptime as possible on your killtarget, regardless of what build you play, it does a lot of maintenance healing and can be an OK burst heal when fully charged. In 90% of cases you will only be casting it at 1 charge for a longer hot. As flameshaper you do not want to spend both charges back to back immediately as it can fuck over your uptime as Verdant Embrace along with your tierset "Eats" the hot to do additional healing.

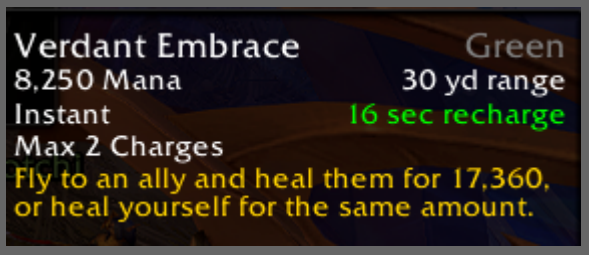


Reversion is not as big of a hot as Dream breath, but is more important to have uptime on. You absolutely want 100% uptime on reversion on anyone taking damage, 2x of it on your killtarget, and 1x on anyone not in danger, this is because **Grace Period** grants 10% healing, this effect is echoable, giving 20% healing when you have 2 reversions up on a target.
Reversion ticks also fish for **Lifespark** procs, if you're playing it, which will give you instant cast living flames which are useful offensively and defensively.

Burst healing:



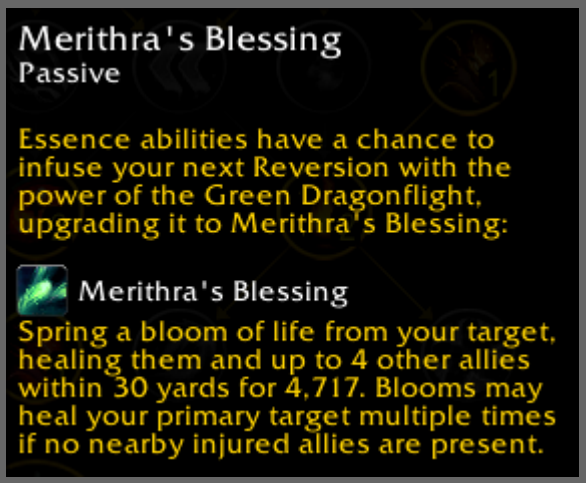
Golden Hour, while Golden hour is not necessarily your top heal in arena, it is the most important to understand. The most common mistake of new evokers is underusing Golden hour. Casting reversion gives you this effect, and its healing will scale based on how much damage someone has taken recently, this means that if someone has been hit by a lot of damage recently, you should cast Echo Reversion above anything else, even if you already have the reversion hot up, as golden hour only applies to the initial cast of reversion. This is your biggest burst heal, but only if someone has taken big damage less than 5 seconds ago.



Verdant Embrace is your best single target heal when golden hour is on cooldown or not going to heal a lot, Verdant embrace is a multi-functional CD, that lets you move to a teammate quickly and you should feel free to use it both for it's burst healing or mobility.

Flameshaper: If you're playing flameshaper you should ideally only cast Verdant Embrace when Dream breath is up. This is because of your inner flame talent, that "Eats" part of the Dream breath hot and makes it heal instantly for double the healing it'd do as a hot, this makes Verdant a really big heal on Flameshaper but only if you have dream breath up, this will also mean you will have to refresh dream breath a lot more often than Chronowarden.

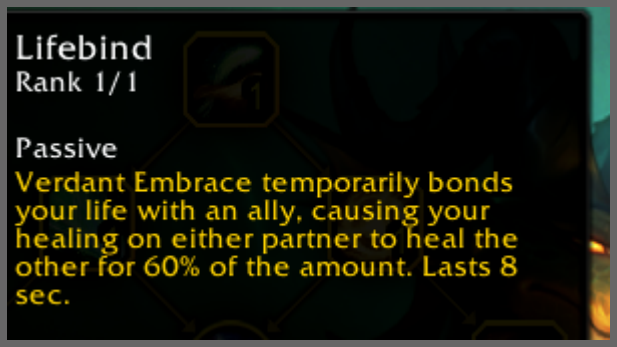
Chronowarden: If you're playing Chronowarden, Verdant embrace has a hot component attached to it, which is a decently beefy hot, additionally you have to cast Verdant Embrace to keep up your Primacy buff to maintain your haste, you can stack Primacy faster by echoing Verdant.



Merithra's blessing is a little green bouncing ball that jumps between people missing HP, Meritra is a big burst healing, if you abuse it's smart healing to your advantage: Merithra like many other Evoker spells is echoable, both on your primary target but also other targets, this means you get 1 extra green ball per echo, these balls will try and find someone else to bounce on if your target is full hp. This means that you can echo your full hp teammate and

the ball will bounce onto the guy missing hp, this can give up to 4x more single target healing from a Merhitra's blessing cast, compared to just hardcasting it without echo.

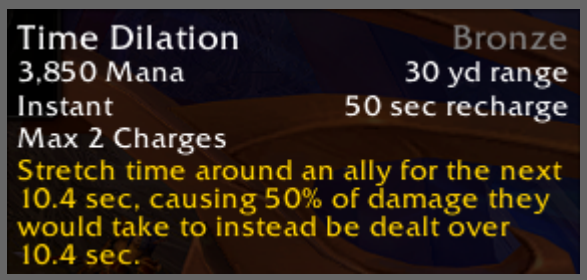
This should not be done every Merthra's cast, as you will be turbo essence starved, but it's important to be aware of and there are times where sending some green balls will be better than pressing Verdant Embrace, casting Merithra will also still do all normal Reversion effects, like Golden hour.



Verdant Embrace also places Lifebind onto your primary target (it doesn't follow echo), lifebind copies 60% of healing on yourself to your target and vice versa, this is insanely valuable, as you can effectively give some of your hots to another target, lifebind works on ALL healing you do, including cooldowns. Lifebind should be at the back of your mind when you are healing, high consistent damage where hotting yourself can make you do a lot more healing to your teammate.

Note that Lifebind includes overhealing, so hots in yourself while you are full hp will still copy onto your teammate.

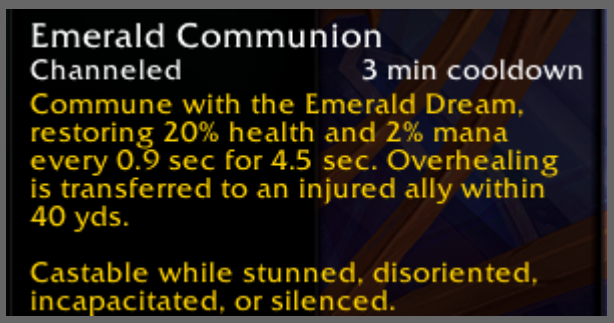
Cooldowns



Time dilation is your bread and butter rotational cooldown, if damage is too high or you know you're about to get CC'd you should always press Time dilation, if you're in doubt you should always press it rather than hold it, it's your "First line of defence", and should always be the cooldown you trade first.

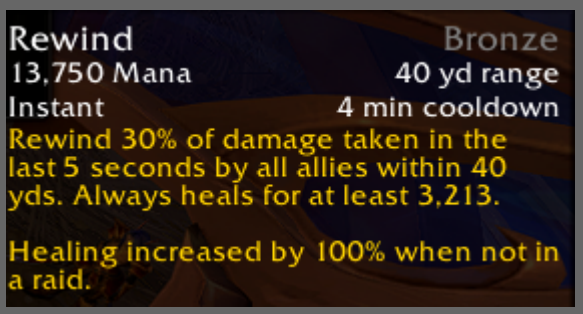
It's important to note that Time dilation does not prevent any damage, and you will have to heal the entire thing eventually, you basically just turn your dps into a brewmaster monk for 10 seconds.
With our powerful hots and golden hour it's a lot easier to heal the same amount of damage spread out rather than burst, if your teammate is not getting oneshot and you're out of CC,

you can outheal it. Time Dilation is how you make sure they don't get oneshot between your globals.



Emerald communion is your heal button when you're in CC. It's a fairly simple cooldown, but it has a lot of jank and counterplay, which makes figuring out when you should use it a lot harder, the choice is hard to do in the moment and even top evoker mains and myself get it wrong all the time, here's what you need to know:

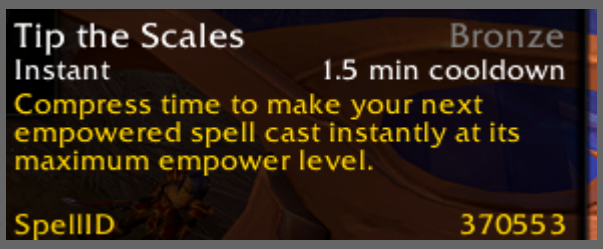
- **You need to be full HP**, communion will always heal you before it heals the lowest hp teammate, this means if you are stunned at 50% hp and your teammate is 30% hp, communion will always heal you over your teammate, and you should trinket rather than use communion, if you do not have time for it to heal yourself first.
- **Emerald communion is reduced by dampening**, if you're playing solo shuffle you should try to trade communion early in the round, as late in the round it will do absolutely nothing.
- **Communion restores mana**, if you're playing a long game in 3v3, you need to find an excuse to communion early, so that you can get mana back and get another use of communion later.
- **Communion requires LOS** if someone is out of your line of sight, they will not be healed, this includes smokebomb, mage ice wall and other ways line of sight is applied. Many rogues will hold smoke bomb specifically for when you press communion, you can outplay this by parking yourself ontop of your teammate, but this should only be done if you have no trinket, as it can fuck you over in other ways.
- **Communion can be cycloned** Communion can be completely outplayed by Cyclone and other effects that "Banish" you, like undispellable hunter trap. If you know a cyclone is coming soon you should under no circumstances press communion, unless it's your last option.
- **Communion is single target,** Communion does a lot of healing, but only to 1 person at a time, the way to play around this is putting up lifebind ahead of time, as communion healing can be lifebinded, this is not always doable as you usually press communion while in CC, if everyone is dying and you have trinket and communion, you should always trinket.



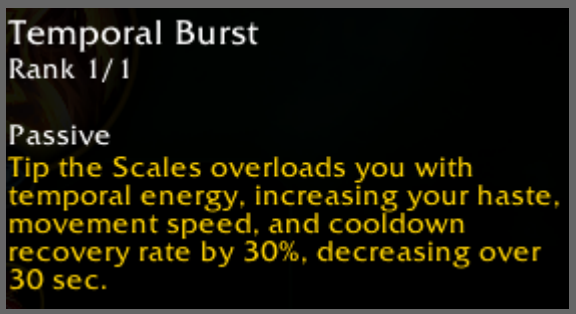
Rewind is your classic “Oh shit” button. Rewind is basically an AOE giga Golden Hour, it restores 90% of all damage taken in the last 5 seconds, and is very valuable if you are falling behind on healing and you can often combo it with your trinket with a caveat:

- **Rewind is countered by cyclone**, but not in the way you might think, to understand when you can rewind you need to understand how the game tracks how much damage you and your teammates have taken:

  Damage is tracked via. a hidden buff on your character, this includes your teammates. Because cyclones and similar spells make you immune to everything, this includes this hidden buff. So when you exit a cyclone, no matter what Rewind and Golden Hour will do their minimum healing, because the game has forgotten how much damage people take. This bug has been in since the Evoker released and will likely never be fixed, so you have to get used to playing around it.



Tip the Scales makes your next empower spell instant and fully empowered, most of the time you will use this on an instant cast fire breath, but it can be good for dreambreath if you have no other burst healing available, but generally it’s bad to Tip Dream breath.

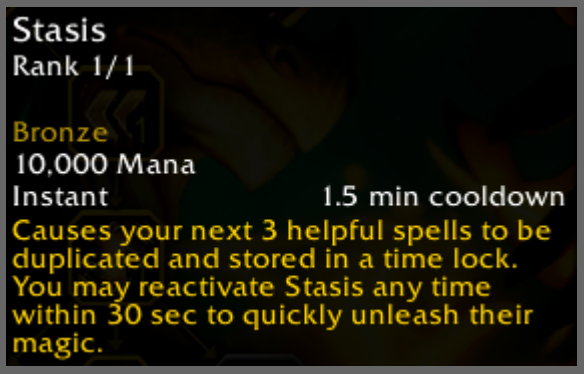


On Chronowarden Tip triggers Temporal Burst and gives you an enormous amount of haste and cooldown reduction. In most cases this is basically a DPS cooldown on a healer, and you should treat it as such, use it when your team is bursting to try and help land kills, following up the Tip Firebreath with chrono flame or Disintegrate spam.



Obsidian Scales is your personal damage reduction, and you shouldn't be scared to press it, use it before you think you're about to get CC'd, as a trade into enemy offensive cooldowns or in combination with the Obsidian Mettle PVP talent to secure important sleepwalks.

As flameshaper Obsidian scales copies itself onto your target for a 15% damage reduction, this is very valuable, and you can trade it kind of like how you would Time Dilation, however try and keep 1 charge for yourself, good players will notice when you don't have wall and swap to you.



Stasis is quite simple on the surface, you press stasis and the next 3 spells you press will be saved for later, it's important to remember Stasis remembers your target and you are "Locked in" to who you want to heal with stasis when you build it. In PVP stasis is really powerful specifically because of it's special interaction with CC:

With: /cancelaura Stasis
You can cancel stasis even in cc, firing off your saved spells. But you can only cast Verdant Embrace and Dream breath in cc, echo, reversion, merithra will not work in stasis if you release it while cc'd.

This makes our default Stasis combo the following:

Dream breath -> Verdant embrace -> Verdant embrace

This will make you cast dreambreath, which will refresh your hot (important for Flameshaper) and if your chronowarden shoots out chrono flames, via. AfterImages. Verdant Embrace is your burst heal and as echo cannot be saved in stasis you will ideally want to save two hard casted Verdants into it.

You can either spread out your Verdants between 2 targets or try and predict who your enemy will attack and put both verdants into 1 target.
A well executed stasis will save you from having to use your trinket or communion where you otherwise would have to.

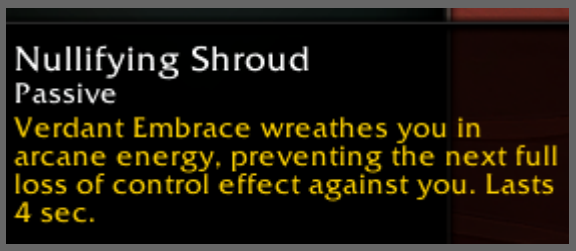
Note: You can use stasis in the starting room of a match, but only if you don't "Finish" building the stasis before the gates open, this will mean that you can do the following:

Stasis -> Dreambreath fully empowered -> Dreambreath fully empowered

Afterwards you can press Verdant Embrace once the gate opens, and you'll have your stasis ready instantly.

CC immunity

The biggest thing separating a great evoker from a good one is your ability to not get CC'd in the first place. Our high HPS scales with how much damage people take, so it is very hard to kill anything an evoker is healing unless they are in CC. This makes it critical you make yourself as annoying as possible to CC.

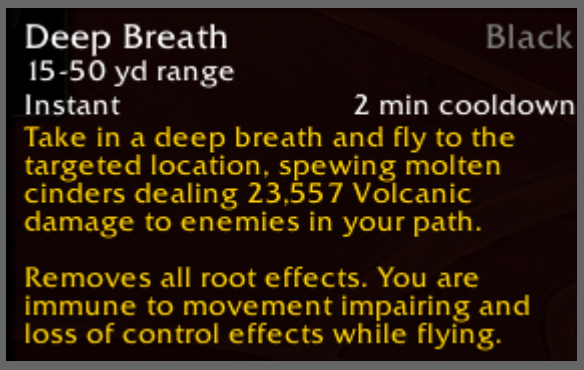


Nullifying shroud is now tied to Verdant Embrace, and it's NEVER a misplay to press verdant embrace to try and avoid cc you think is incoming. If you can you should try and always have 1 charge of Verdant embrace saved up in the bag to use for CC immunity. This spell will make you accidentally avoid cc sometimes, but being smart about it is how you see those clips of evokers being impossible to lock down for ages.

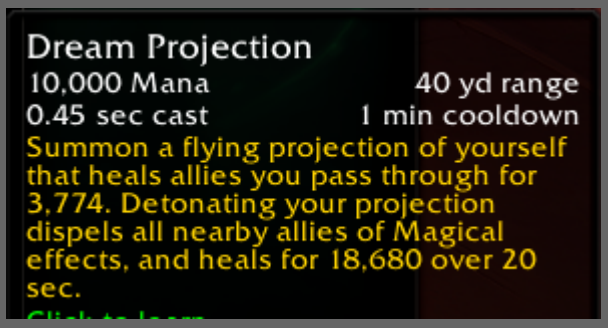


Time stop is a "Self-cyclone" that you can cancel, while in Time stop you are immune to everything. High end evokers will often use Time stop on themselves when they are expecting CC, making themselves immune before quickly cancelling time stop again.

Time stop is not as valuable as nullifying shroud due to its longer cooldown and the fact it freezes your character, however it is worth considering in CC heavy matchups. You'll generally want to use Timestop AFTER you run out of verdant embrace stacks in most cases.



Deep breath is mainly your stun, but while you're in the deep breath animation you are completely CC immune. This is another way to avoid CC in a pinch if verdant and timestop are on cooldown, or if you are playing with something like a subrogue and your team does not need your stun.



Dream Projection is your AOE dispel. This is old Dragonflight tech that is not used as often anymore because of the strength of Nullifying shroud and timestop, but it's valuable to know how to use it:
Dream projection works by summoning a pet that you control and pick where you want it to explode and dispel everyone.
However, if you are CC'd, Dream Projection will automatically cancel itself and explode, this means if you get hit by any magic CC while channeling, like a polymorph, it will explode and automatically dispel you. This is extremely valuable as unlike the other ways of avoiding CC, a dream projection dispel means you will now be on DR.

The problem with Dream Projection is that it's easily outplayed, you have to precast it and hold the channel till the cc hits, this means that often people will just interrupt you and then CC you, or even ignore you as you are not doing anything valuable while channeling.